

Blake Wood Resume

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University <i>Master of Science in Machine Learning and Data Science, GPA: 4.0</i>	Evanston, IL Sept. 2025 – Dec. 2026 (Expected)
University of Florida <i>Bachelor of Science in Data Science, GPA: 3.83</i>	Gainesville, FL Aug. 2021 – May 2025

EXPERIENCE

Walt Disney World <i>Associate Data Scientist</i>	Lake Buena Vista, FL & Remote June 2025 – Present (Remote)
- Lead development of scalable ML models for proactive attraction maintenance, expanding predictive maintenance work across multiple rides. - Collaborate with engineers and operations to productionize models and improve scheduling decisions.	
<i>Data Science Intern</i>	Jan. 2025 – June 2025 (On-site)
- Developed ML pipeline to detect track switch failures on Cosmic Rewind; achieved 96% downtime detection with 88% predicted ≥ 1 day in advance. - Proof of concept now being scaled across track switches and attractions for overnight maintenance.	
University of Florida <i>NSF Undergraduate Researcher (Gator Glaciology)</i>	Gainesville, FL Jan. 2023 – Dec. 2024
- Analyzed radar data from West Antarctica's Thwaites Glacier with Python, producing visualizations and insights on ice-sheet structure. - Created PyPMT, a Python package supporting 2D/3D visualization, interpolation, and data processing for polar datasets.	
University of Florida <i>Undergraduate Researcher (AI at the Florida Museum of Natural History)</i>	Gainesville, FL June 2023 – Dec. 2024
- Analyzed plague and environmental datasets in R, producing network simulations of disease spread over realistic topographies. - Processed LiDAR data using Python, R, and ArcGIS Pro to detect archaeological sites near Ft. Myers, FL.	
KidzHack <i>Software Engineering Intern</i>	Gainesville, FL Jan. 2024 – May 2024
- Designed and implemented API integrations and ETL pipelines during the beta phase of the KidzHack platform. - Applied NLP for sentiment analysis to support user experience features.	

PROJECTS

PyPMT <i>University of Florida</i>	June 2023 – Dec. 2024 Gainesville, FL
Developed an open-source Python library for glacier research with 2D/3D visualizations, interpolation methods, and built-in data processing for polar datasets.	
Spotipy <i>University of Florida</i>	April 2023 Gainesville, FL
Built a Python tool using the Spotify Web API with NLP and clustering to provide lyric-matching and song recommendations.	
Black Death Analysis <i>University of Florida</i>	June 2023 – May 2024 Gainesville, FL
Created an R-Shiny app and network visualizations to simulate plague spread and analyze environmental time series trends.	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, R, C++, SQL, VB.NET

Libraries: Pandas, Numpy, Matplotlib, Scikit-Learn, Keras, SciPy, Plotly, Tensorflow, etc.